SUBJECT: Academic Software Management

RELATED DOCUMENTS

ITD 7830 Equipment and Software Technical Support.

SECTION 1 POLICY STATEMENT

1.1. Khalifa University of Science and Technology (KU) manages software assets so as to derive the maximum benefit to KU and its faculty, students, research support staff and staff. Software installed on KU's computers and computer networks must have a license, and be used in accordance with the license conditions. Academic software purchases must be coordinated through a single department.

SECTION 2 SCOPE AND APPLICABILITY

2.1. This policy document applies to all faculty, staff, and students and any other affiliates of Khalifa University of Science and Technology, all referred to here as "Users".

SECTION 3 PURPOSE

3.1. The primary purpose of this policy is to define how academic software at KU is acquired, managed and used on KU resources in order to protect the user and KU from illegal or damaging actions by individuals, either knowingly or unknowingly, and to maximize the value from software assets while ensuring that faculty, students, research support staff and staff have the tools to accomplish their teaching, learning and research efficiently.

SECTION 4 DEFINITIONS

The following definition(s) apply to this policy document:

4.1. **Academic Software**: Software used for Khalifa University of Science and Technology course teaching, learning or academic research, as opposed to commercial research.

4.2. **Research Computing Steering Committee (RCSC):** The governing body of Research Computing.

SECTION 5 PROVISIONS AND GUIDELINES

5.1. *Use of Software*

5.1.1. Software installed on Khalifa University of Science and Technology (KU) computers and computer networks must have a license, and be used in accordance with the license conditions. All users are responsible for ensuring that they adhere to the appropriate license terms.

The online version of this policy document is definitive.

5.2. *Funding Streams for Software and Purchase Coordination*

5.2.1. Multiple funding streams exist for purchasing software including, but not limited to, internally and externally funded research projects, departmental funding and central funding.

5.2.2. Software acquisition and management is coordinated through the university's IT department. The department maintains and publishes accurate and up to date records of all available software.

5.2.3. The IT department establishes, maintains and makes available standards, guidelines and processes to support this policy.

5.3. *Identifying and Approving Software*

5.3.1. Software for Teaching: Software required for teaching must be linked to a specific academic course or courses. This software needs to be approved by the appropriate department chair or academic committee. IT must be consulted to advise on whether software is already available or if suitable alternatives exist and on the suitability of the software for KU's computing environment.

5.3.2. Software for Research: Research software may be funded centrally through the Research Computing (RC) department's budget, or funded through a research project's budget or through an Institute's or academic department's budget.

5.3.2.1. RC advises and consults with faculty members at the project proposal development stage to assist in identifying software and computational requirements.

5.3.2.2. RC also collaborates with research administration offices to provide feedback and review on project proposals with regards to software, computational, and support requirements, as well as provide up to date information on available software, computational resources and services.

5.4. *Acquisition and Budgeting for Software Assets*

5.4.1. All academic software to be acquired for use on KU's computer equipment must be purchased through the IT department, regardless of the funding stream. This is to ensure that the university has a complete record of all purchased software, can register, support and upgrade the software accordingly, and that software usage information can be collected.

5.4.2. Software funded by research projects, departments, institutes and the RC department is purchased through the IT department and cost allocated to the appropriate budget as per the normal procurement procedures.

5.4.3. Where possible, networked licenses should be purchased in preference to standalone or single machine licenses.

5.5. *License Management, Support Costs and Retiring of Software*

5.5.1. The IT department optimizes the number of licenses acquired so as to maximize KU's existing investment in software. This is facilitated by the monitoring of license usage of all licensed academic software. Users ensure that the appropriate monitoring tool provided by IT is available on their computers for this purpose.

SECTION 6 RESPONSIBILITIES

6.1. The IT department establishes, maintains and publishes a software catalogue.
6.2. The IT department monitors software usage.
6.3. The Research Computing department consults with research administration offices on grant awards, as regards to software, computational, and support requirements.
6.4. All users are responsible for using software in accordance with the appropriate license terms.

SECTION 7 REVIEW STATEMENT

7.1. This policy document is reviewed once every four (4) years or more frequently when requested by the Provost, SVP Academic and Student Services, or SVP for Research Development.

SECTION 8 APPROVAL AUTHORITY AND REVISION HISTORY

This policy document has been approved by the Khalifa University of Science and Technology's Board of Trustees. Original documentation is on file in the Office of the President. The online version is definitive.

First disseminated by the Office of the Provost on 01 January 2018
Most Recent Review: 01 January 2018
Revision History:

Revision No.	Effective Date	Description
2		
1		
0	01 January 2018	Policy document first adopted.

Next scheduled review: 01 January 2022

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